

A reusable technical report

Strike documentation team, September 2026

Abstract

This report is a template for documents that must remain readable in both a browser and a paged PDF. It separates a full-width abstract and contents from a source-ordered, two-column body. Its companion paper.sxh supplies a serif face, a narrower measure, generous leading, and three reusable command groups. The exercise tests the same source against two renderers without asking the author to write separate versions of the report.

Keywords: document structure, column flow, typography, reusable components

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Question

How can one document be pleasant to read in a browser while carrying enough structure for a later PDF renderer? The content records meaning; the header chooses a serif face, a measured line, and line spacing for this project. The flow(2) group begins after the abstract and contents, so both remain full-width while the report body uses two columns.

The aside alias expands to skinny(72%) color(muted). It is reusable across documents without repeating the command chain.

Method

Source

Write headings, prose, and command groups in the source document. Keep the section order explicit. A renderer may change line breaks, but it must preserve the order of headings,

paragraphs, figures, and references.

Presentation

Keep page typography in the shared .sxh header. The header is loaded by strike.yaml, then layered with any site header. Aliases are resolved before either renderer walks the document tree.

A compact code explanation

```
const result = try render(source, .{ .sheet = header });
```

The call passes the same header to every document in the project. The code-note alias gives the explanation a consistent muted treatment. The source line is an example of where configuration enters the pipeline; neither renderer needs to parse typography out of prose.

Result

The table of contents, comparison, aside, and code explanation remain ordinary document structure. Their presentation can change without changing the prose. The body moves from the first column to the second in source order. A longer version continues on the next physical page in PDF; HTML keeps the same ordered content in a column container.

Discussion

Two renderers need different measurement engines. HTML delegates

line and column breaks to CSS. The native PDF backend measures in points and advances to another column when the remaining height is too small. Both receive the same parsed headings, paragraphs, code, and groups. This distinction matters: the document states what flows, while each backend decides where a line break occurs.

The template also shows a current limitation. A wide figure inside the body has no accepted span command yet. Place full-width material before or after the flow group, or use a narrower figure that fits one column. A later design decision can add a span form without changing this document's reading order.

Conclusion

A report template is useful when the source remains ordinary enough to edit without a layout tool. This one uses headings for navigation, a header for typographic defaults, aliases for recurring components, and one flow group for the main body. Each piece has a clear place in the source. That makes the document easier to revise: changing the theme does not move paragraphs, and rewording a section does not require manually reassigning it to a column.